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Lead Developer

Crown Prosecution Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 31st May 2026



**Crown
Prosecution
Service**

Reference number

456943

Salary

£58,330 - £73,520

£58,330 - £67,450 (National) - £62,820 - £73,520 (London) + £3,150 RRA

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Level D

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

CPS - HQ Digital Information Directorate (DID)

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Birmingham, Brighton and Hove, Bristol, Canterbury, Cardiff, Chelmsford, Eastleigh, Exeter, Guildford, Hull, Ipswich, Leeds, Leicester, Liverpool, London, Manchester, Middlesbrough, Mold, Newcastle-upon-Tyne, Norwich, Nottingham, Portsmouth, Preston, Reading, Sheffield, St Albans, Stoke-on-Trent, Swansea, Truro, Wakefield, Warrington, York

About the job

Job summary

Are you a seasoned software engineer ready to lead from the front? We are looking for Lead Developers with broad experience to join our dynamic team and shape the future of digital services at CPS. This is a hands-on leadership role where you combine deep technical expertise with strategic influence, mentor others, and drive delivery across high-impact projects.

You bring extensive experience in C# (12) and .NET 8, with a strong track record in designing and building scalable backend services and RESTful APIs using ASP.NET. Your understanding of cloud-native architectures particularly within Microsoft Azure & use of Function apps is key, alongside a solid grounding in computer science fundamentals, clean architecture, and SOLID principles.

You thrive in agile environments and champion DevSecOps practices.

As a technical authority, you lead developers as part of multidisciplinary teams, shape development standards, and collaborate across departments to deliver secure, accessible, and high-quality digital solutions. You also play a key role in recruitment, skill development, and fostering a culture of continuous improvement.

If you are passionate about modern software engineering, eager to mentor others, and ready to make a tangible impact, we want to hear from you.

As part of this role, you undertake direct line management responsibilities.

Job description

Your roles and responsibilities:

You have an in-depth technical understanding of C# and .NET, and coach and mentor others in their use. Proficient in a range of development tools and skills relevant to your specialism, you are a committed learner who pivots to new skills as the technology ecosystem evolves

You advocate a modern standards approach to software development, including test-driven development (TDD), automated testing, continuous integration, pair programming, code review, and version control

You shape and share digital software development standards that are pragmatic and fit for CPS, recognising and advocating for change where needed

You inform the overarching strategy and define decision-making processes as part of the wider Technical Leadership group within Software Engineering

You write code for complex projects, break down barriers for teams, handle escalations, and plan at a high level while also diving into the detail to make things happen

A copy of the full job description is attached.

Person specification

To be eligible to apply, you need to:

Extensive professional experience in .Net (8), C# (12) development, and with a strong track record of designing, implementing, and maintaining back end services

Developed and implemented RESTful based Web API's using ASP.Net

Understanding of Cloud Native Architectures e.g use of Azure Functions, Function apps & App services

Software Design: Strong Experience in use of Domain Driven Design, Clean Architecture, SOLID and clean code principles

Database Skills : Hands-on experience with Relational Databases (i.e., PostgreSQL/Oracle), including writing and optimizing SQL queries.

Testing: Knowledge of Unit Testing, TDD/BDD, Integration Testing

Agile Methodologies: Proven ability to work in Agile/Scrum environments, with excellent communication and collaboration skills

CI/CD and Version Control: Experience with CI/CD pipelines Version Control Systems (Github), and modern software development practices

Cloud Platforms: Experience with Cloud Platforms, in particular Azure

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Changing and Improving

Managing a Quality Service

We only ask for evidence of these behaviours on your application form:

Leadership

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,330, Crown Prosecution Service contributes £16,898 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

Join the Crown Prosecution Service and find your purpose.

[Why we work for the Crown Prosecution Service](#)

The Crown Prosecution Service is passionate about ensuring that we're a top performing organisation and a great place to work. We're a committed equal

opportunities employer, creating a culture where you can bring your whole self to work, and individuality is truly appreciated.

This culture of inclusion is underpinned by our staff networks covering disability, faith and belief, LGBTQI+, race, social mobility alongside our mental health first aiders programme and wellbeing sessions.

The Crown Prosecution Service commits to offer its employees the following experience.

You can do impactful, purposeful work that's making a difference to your local communities.

You are able to learn and grow, with access to the right opportunities and resources.

We care about your wellbeing.

We want you to feel valued, trusted and included.

We also offer the following range of benefits:

Civil Service contributory pension of up to 28.9%

25 days' leave, increasing to 30 days after 5 years

£350 each year to spend on personal development

lawyer training programme for all new prosecutors

an extra privilege day to mark the King's birthday

competitive maternity, paternity and parental leave

flexible working including flexitime, and a family friendly approach to work

Cycle2Work scheme, employee savings.

Diversity at the Crown Prosecution Service is about inclusion, embracing differences and ensuring our workforce truly reflects the communities we serve. We want you to feel that you belong and can thrive, whatever your background, identity or culture. As a Disability Confident employer, we're

happy to support requests for reasonable adjustments and improve your recruitment experience. If you'd like any reasonable adjustments made to our recruitment process, let us know within your application or contact Ellie.Dixon@cps.gov.uk.

We want to ensure our employees can thrive at work and home and offer a range of support to achieve a balance. This includes flexibility of working hours, flexibility to support caring responsibilities and a flexible approach to deployment. We offer a hybrid working policy. You must spend at least 40% of your contracted hours over a four-week period at court, in an office or another official workplace depending on business need and the kind of work you're doing.

The Crown Prosecution Service also has a range of development programmes to support all aspiring, new and experienced managers with developing the skills, behaviours and knowledge to build their confidence and capability. Our Manager Induction Programme is mandatory for all newly appointed managers. This is a fantastic opportunity to support all our new Crown Prosecution Service managers with the tools required to perform effectively in their roles.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours and Experience.

Recruitment process

The recruitment process consists of an **online application, assessment and interview**. The assessment is expected to take place on the **15 and 16 June 2026**. Successful candidates who pass the assessment, will be invited to attend an interview, these are expected to take place on **24, 25 & 26 June 2026**.

Your interview takes place online through Microsoft Teams. A member of our recruitment team will be in touch with guidance. If you have any queries about this, contact the **Ellie.Dixon@cps.gov.uk**

You should keep these dates free or notify us if you're not available. We'll make every effort to accommodate your date preferences but we can't guarantee it.

Assessment

We ask you to complete an assessment as part of the recruitment process for this role. We will provide details immediately before your interview.

Personal statement

We ask you to complete a personal statement of no more than 1,000 words. You need to demonstrate the following experience/technical skills required for this role, and provide examples:

Extensive professional experience in .Net (8), C# (12) development, and with a strong track record of designing, implementing, and maintaining back end services

Developed and implemented RESTful based Web API's using ASP.Net

Understanding of Cloud Native Architectures e.g use of Azure Functions, Function apps & App services

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CI/CD and Version Control: Experience with CI/CD pipelines Version Control Systems (Github), and modern software development practices

Cloud Platforms: Experience with Cloud Platforms, in particular Azure

In addition, you need to demonstrate the Crown Prosecution Service or Civil Service values.

Behaviours

You are also asked to complete a statement of no more than 250 words for each behaviour setting out how you consider your personal skills, qualities and experience match the specified behaviours and requirements.

1. Leadership - Lead Behaviour

You also need to demonstrate the Crown Prosecution Service or Civil Service values.

The panel has the right to assess the lead behaviour LEADERSHIP first. If the standard on this behaviour isn't met, the other behaviours won't be considered and your application won't progress. The panel also has the right to raise the minimum standard pass mark. The panel may also refer to the lead behaviour at the interview stage to determine merit order.

Interview/Assessment

We use behaviours to help us understand your experience, to see if you're a good fit for the role. You are assessed against (Grade 7) in the Civil Service

success profiles [behaviours framework](#). We are assessing three behaviours at interview stage

1. Leadership Interview
2. Changing & Improving - Interview
3. Managing a Quality Service - Interview

CV

You're not required to upload your CV. However, when submitting your application there is a CV section. You are required to provide information about your employment and/or academic history for the past three years. **The CV section will be assessed.**

It's your responsibility to provide the specified information in the requested format to ensure that you're considered for the post.

If you're unable to cover three years through employment or academic history, you must provide a character reference for clearance purposes.

Strengths

Strengths are tested at interview stage - the strengths tested are not shared before the interview.

Other

This is a full-time post. We do consider requests for flexible, part-time working and job share, always considering the operational needs of the department.

Please note that the CPS is unable to offer visa sponsorship. Therefore, if you require visa sponsorship to work in the UK, you will not meet the eligibility criteria for this role.

Clearance

If successful, you are required to secure a Disclosure and Barring Service check and Security Check clearance, for which you must have a current valid UK address.

If successfully appointed, we ask you to complete a character enquiry form and nationality and immigration questionnaire and national security vetting form.

If you're a Crown Prosecution Service member of staff, you won't need to do a Disclosure and Barring Service check as you already hold this clearance.

The job you're applying for is covered by Article 3(a) of the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974 (Exceptions) Order 1975, consequently Section 4(2) of that Act doesn't apply. You're required to disclose all previous convictions and cautions including spent convictions. Failing to make a full declaration will result in withdrawing your offer of employment if our checks reveal convictions that haven't been disclosed.

To be cleared to Security Check clearance level, you have to be able to meet the residency requirement in the Cabinet Office guidance. For the Crown Prosecution Service they are:

Security Clearance three years within the last five years

Reserve list

If you're recommended by the selection panel but not appointed to the current vacancy, you're put on a reserve list for 12 months. You may be offered another Lead Developer post in the Digital and Information Directorate if a vacancy comes up during this period. We may also approach candidates on the waiting list to fill other roles that require similar knowledge and experience.

Feedback

We only provide feedback if you attend an interview or assessment.

Fraud check

The Crown Prosecution Service provides a Fair Processing Notice to all new applicants after they've been successful at interview. These candidates are

informed that, as one aspect of pre-employment screening, their personal details – name, National Insurance number and date of birth – are checked against the Internal Fraud Database. We won't employ anyone included on the database unless they can demonstrate exceptional circumstances.

The Strategic Resourcing team in the Crown Prosecution Service will, on behalf of the vacancy holder, inform applicants when they are refused employment because of their inclusion in the Internal Fraud Database.

Civil Service Commission

If you're dissatisfied with the recruitment process and wish to make a complaint, please contact Strategic.Resourcing@cps.gov.uk with your concerns.

If you remain dissatisfied and wish to make a further complaint, please click on the following link to the Civil Service Commission complaints page [Recruitment Complaints - Civil Service Commission](#)

Civil Service Commission Recruitment Principles can be found at <https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/recruitment/>

Details of the Civil Service Nationality Rules are located at: <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/nationality-rules>

Candidates are subject to UK immigration requirements. For the most up-to-date information on the requirements of working in the UK, please go to the UK Visas and Immigration website at <https://www.gov.uk/browse/visas-immigration/work-visas>

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Ellie Dixon

Email : Ellie.Dixon@cps.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : strategic.resourcing@cps.gov.uk

